

THE INITIATE

For all of known history the Kinkou order existed to preserve the balance. Mediators of the spirit world, the clan's headquarters lie in the far off lands of Ionia, but its adepts walk all the lands.

○ **CHARM**

- Manipulate Someone

○ **COOL**

- Act Under Pressure
- Help Out

○ **SHARP**

- Investigate a Mystery
- Read a Bad Situation

○ **TOUGH**

- Kick Some Ass
- Protect Someone

○ **WEIRD**

- Use Magic

LUCK

Mark luck to change a roll to 12 or avoid all harm.

□□

Initiate special: When you spend a point of Luck, something goes wrong for your Sect: an ill-advised project or a disastrous operation.

HARM

When you reach 4 or more, mark unstable.

Okay □□□□□□□□□□ Dying

Unstable: □

(Unstable injuries will worsen as time passes)

EXPERIENCE

Experience: □□□□□□

Whenever you roll and get a total of 6 or less, or when a move tells you to, mark an experience box.

MOVES

You get all of the basic moves, plus four Initiate moves. You get this one:

- When you are in good standing with your Sect, at the beginning of each mystery, roll +Charm. On a 10+ they provide some useful info or help in the field. On a 7-9 you get a mission associated with the mystery, and if you do it you'll get some info or help too. On a miss, they ask you to do something bad. If you fail a mission or refuse an order, you'll be in trouble with the Sect until you atone.

Then pick three of these:

- **Pruning the Tree:** When using an old-fashioned hand weapon, you inflict +1 harm and get +1 whenever you roll **protect someone**.
- **Mystic:** Every time you successfully **use magic**, take +1 forward.
- **Fortunes:** The Sect has ancient prophecies or divination techniques to predict the future. Once per mystery, you may use them. If you **look at what the future holds**, roll +Weird. On a 10+ hold 3, and on a 7-9 hold 1. On a miss, you get bad information and the Keeper decides how that affects you. Spend your hold to:
 - have a useful object ready.
 - be somewhere you are needed, just in time.
 - take +1 forward, or give +1 forward to another hunter.
 - retroactively warn someone about an attack, so that it doesn't happen.

- **Coursing the Sun:** When you pass judgment to determine whether something upholds or disrupts the balance of the world, roll +Weird.
 - On a 10+, ask two questions from the list. You take +1 forward acting on the information.
 - On a 7-9, ask one question from the list.
 - On a miss, your judgment is flawed and you receive bad information.

Questions:

- What is their true intention?
- Are their actions in harmony?
- Who or what would suffer most from their current path?

- **Mentor:** You have a mentor in the Sect: name them. When you **contact your mentor for info**, roll +Sharp. On a 10+, you get an answer to your question, no problem. On a 7-9 you choose: they're either busy and can't help, or they answer the question but you owe a favour. On a miss, your question causes trouble.

- **Apprentice:** You have an apprentice: name them. Your job is to teach them the Sect's ways. They count as an **ally: subordinate** (motivation: to follow your instructions to the letter).

- **Helping Hand:** When you successfully **help out** another hunter, they get +2 instead of the usual +1.

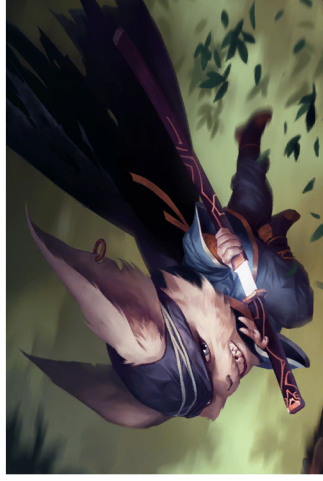
- **Watching the Stars:** When you **use magic**, you can ask a question from the **investigate a mystery** move as your effect.

GEAR

You get old-fashioned armour (1-armour).

Old-fashioned weapons (pick three):

- Spirit Knife (1-harm hand spirit-magic small)
- Fighting Sticks (1-harm hand quick)
- Staff (1-harm hand useful innocuous balanced)
- Dual Kamas (2-harm hand messy)
- Sword (2-harm hand messy)
- Big Sword (3-harm hand messy heavy)
- Kusari-gama (1-harm hand/close restraining)
- Spear (2-harm hand/close)
- Shuriken/Kunai (1-harm close many)
- Scout's bow (1-harm far reload)



GETTING STARTED

To make your Initiate, first pick a name. Then follow the instructions in this playbook to decide your look, ratings, moves, Sect, and gear. Finally, introduce yourself and pick history.

PRONOUNS: _____

LOOK, PICK ONE FROM EACH LIST:

- Hardened body, tattooed body, agile body, strong body, thin body, angular body, hunched body, _____ body.
- Archaic clothes, unfashionable clothes, ceremonial clothes, mismatched clothes, formal clothes, _____ clothes.

RATINGS, PICK ONE LINE:

- ☐ Charm-1, Cool+1, Sharp=0, Tough+1, Weird+2
- ☐ Charm=0, Cool+1, Sharp+1, Tough-1, Weird+2
- ☐ Charm-1, Cool=0, Sharp-1, Tough+2, Weird+2
- ☐ Charm+1, Cool-1, Sharp+1, Tough=0, Weird+2
- ☐ Charm=0, Cool=0, Sharp=0, Tough+1, Weird+2

SECT

The Kinkou Order is and old ionian Sect with ninjas that work to maintain the balance between the mortal and the spirit worlds. Its two leaders are the Eye of Twilight and the Heart of the Tempest.

The sect will have some positive and negative aspects. You are free to choose some of them below.

Good Traditions (pick ~~two~~ ¹):

- ☐ Knowledgeable
- ☐ Ancient lore
- ☐ Magical lore
- ☒ Fighting arts
- ☐ ~~Modernised~~
- ☐ Chapters everywhere
- ☐ Secular power
- ☐ Flexible tactics
- ☐ Open hierarchy
- ☐ Integrated in society
- ☐ Rich
- ☐ ~~Nifty gadgets~~
- ☐ Magical items

Bad Traditions (pick one):

- ☐ ~~Devious motives~~
- ☐ Tradition-bound
- ☐ Short-sighted
- ☐ Paranoid and secretive
- ☐ Closed hierarchy
- ☐ Factionalised
- ☐ Strict laws
- ☐ ~~Mystical oaths~~
- ☐ ~~Total obedience~~
- ☐ ~~Tyrannical leaders~~
- ☐ Obsolete gear
- ☐ Poor

INTRODUCTIONS

When you get here, wait for everyone to catch up so you can do your introductions together.

Go around the group. On your turn, introduce your Initiate by name and look, and tell the group what they know about you.

HISTORY

Go around the group again. On your turn, pick one for each of the other hunters:

- They are a lay member of your Sect.
- You fought together when the tide of monsters seemed unstoppable. Ask them how it went.
- Friends, but they first met you under your cover identity, and learned about the Sect later. Ask how they feel about that.
- They are your close relative, or partner/spouse. Decide between you exactly what the relationship is.
- Fellow ancient weapons/martial arts club members.
- They're described in the prophecies, but the role they will play isn't stated.
- An ex-member of the Sect, but still friends. Ask them why they left or got thrown out
- You met researching mystical weirdness, and you've been occult comrades ever since.



LEVELING UP

When you have filled all five experience boxes, you level up. Erase the marks and pick an improvement from the following list:

IMPROVEMENTS

- ☐ Get +1 Weird, max +3
- ☐ Get +1 Cool, max +2
- ☐ Get +1 Sharp, max +2
- ☐ Get +1 Tough, max +2
- ☐ Take another Initiate move
- ☐ Take another Initiate move
- ☐ Get command of your chapter of the Sect
- ☐ Get a Sect team under your command
- ☐ Take a move from another playbook
- ☐ Take a move from another playbook

After you have leveled up *five* times, you qualify for advanced improvements in addition to these. They're below.

ADVANCED IMPROVEMENTS

- ☐ Get +1 to any rating, max +3.
- ☐ Change this hunter to a new type.
- ☐ Create a second hunter to play as well as this one.
- ☐ Mark two of the basic moves as advanced.
- ☐ Mark another two of the basic moves as advanced.
- ☐ Retire this hunter to safety.
- ☐ Become the leader, or effective leader, of the whole Sect.
- ☐ Get back one used Luck point.